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From the Chief Editor's Desk

By the passage of time the change in life style was not conducive any more for the collective well being of human kind. Reversing the course of progress which now got entered more on scientific advents than ethics and consciousness ruled out adherence to the ancient mode of living conducive to spiritual completion passed into oblivion by and by. Gautama Smriti says - "The ultimate religion of man is self realisation through yoga." This was either meant for a chosen few or some more lenient and contemporarily consistent alternatives had to be sought out. This accounts for the generation of Yoga tantra or yoga as it comes from tantric canons instead of the stoic Vedic philosophy. Votaries of tantricism differed only in as much as the total acceptance, partial acceptance or total negation of the authority of the vedas as the ultimate testimony of evidence was concerned. Hence, we have - *vama*, *daxa* and *misra* schools of tantricism and yogic practices based on them.

In the orient tradition of metaphysics, there are three testimonies of evidence viz direct perception, inference, and the revelations. The last one in its original form used to be propagated in the form of viva voce tradition which means to say that it was already in vogue even before man wrote down his first letter. Ancient mystics relate words and meaning and their order to assert their particular commitment. Word predates meaning, meaning follows word or both spring forth concomitantly. A great Sanskrit laureate Bhavbhuti in his drama *Uttararamcharitra* has postulated "The meaning follows words in the utterances of worldly gentlemen but in the expressions of hoary seers of the past [referring to Vedic sages] word trails the meaning". There is yet another school arcane though which maintains that both word and meaning are concurrently generated. The last theory is more consistent in the case of the monosyllabic origin of the word as it is known in linguistics. This school of thought was prophesied by Upavarsacharya the preceptor of panini the first exponent of descriptive grammar he opined that "syllables were words". All mystic schools caricatured on the edifice of this axiom of the innate word and meaning relationship developed into a sophisticated system of tantra in which all vowels and consonants were attributed to their basic constituents of the universal phenomena called tattwas in Sanskrit. The universe as such comprises word and meaning synopses and emanates from a source where collective word called nada and collective meaning called Bindu is in a state of perfect homogeneity. The universal manifestation is defined in terms of the separation and the proportion of their deviation determines the subtlety and grossness of manifestation. This is the twilight zone of self-evident awareness and grosser manifestations at subtle and gross levels of the meaning part of the phenomena as well well as their whole form of gradations of homogeneous consciousness - the unmanifest chaos, the conceived expression, and the expressible word. The deep and prolonged meditational trance that must have preceded the realisation of this awareness can be imagined very well. It is beyond a simpleton's capacity of decoding and ascertaining the purport of revelations. so ultimately it is the word of mouth of a seer who is authentic and capable enough to render them suitable for a commoner's comprehension-such an entity has been called as "APTA" or-authentic and his declamations - agamas. There is a commonplace adage regarding the origin of the agamas from the "shivas mouth" received by shakti. They are received by shakti and are vindicated by Vishnu the revelations are

rendered simpler to suit Shaktis assimilation and the modifications the revelations undergo in this process are indicated by the sustaining principle as consistent and efficacious. Tantra Sara a brief synopsis of Abhinav Gupta's Tantraloka a bulky compendium on tantrism tells us about their origin -from five, ten, and sixty-four sources. This indicates - five mouths of lord shiva, ten mudras, and sixty-four tantric lineages. The authenticity of the agamas or let us say only agama has always been a disputed issue since most of the theistic believers would not buy anything that has not originated from the revelations or conflicts with them in any way. Some accept their authority as the testimony of evidence only with their subservience to the Vedas. The last category who accept their authenticity irrespective of their Vedic relevance are either the exponents of direct intuitive insight into their essential nature which needless to say is also the origin of all revelations or the freelancer who deliberately reject the limitations of all scriptural injunctions as impediments in the path of their relishing the spiritual bliss. this bliss as the last category maintains - also manifests in the form of gross physical sensuous pleasures. What ethical injunction and ordenance can pertain any more to an adept who is treading a path beyond that leads beyond the Three Gunas.

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The postulate of Completion –

Reflection on the properties of zero and infinity from a metaphysical perspective .

Key words

Poornam , nistha, anandam

Complete, or the whole, like infinity of maths and logic is another abstract value that must be comprehended with due rational precision. The notion of completion or poornam must contain both objective as well as subjective phenomena within its domain without allowing any actual intersection or subsets. The very process of intersecting will render its completeness inconsistent.

Thus, there are two notions of poornam — subjective and conscious stand point, and another from an objective standpoint. Ancient seers have opined with the subjective one, poorna or complete as a conscious entity rather than a mathematical function. Hence, we have the materialistic properties of infinity and spiritualistic “behaviour” of the holistic being. Other types of positive and negative are conceptual entities. Completeness, bliss and infinity are synonymous according to Sanskrit etymology and glossary of upanishadic terms. Anandam and completion are considered as one and the same entity — bliss, immortality and complete or bhuma are one and the same description of a similar attribute. This cannot be learnt grammatically but through the doctrine of the Upanishad itself — *yo vya bhuma tat sukham, yadalpam tanmartyam*.

Bhuma, or the complete one is bliss that ever is incomplete is death. Thus, *bhuma* is also eternal or immortal.

These are not unnecessary elaborations and over exemplifications. Because when one has to evaluate poornam or the complete, as not different from completeness and the process of completion, one must borrow similar notions from elsewhere in the Upanishads as well.

Poornam as a subjective and conscious entities — is explained etymologically as derived from the root *puri* with the suffix called *ktā* that is used to denote the perfect past participle.

In *swartha*, or the subjective sense – poorna has been derived to mean an entity that is self content or complete by itself because if relative completion were to be taken in to account, there must exist a time or space in which the incomplete must be conceptualised as the a priori of the completion which again doesn't convey the entire meaning of the word poornam or complete.

“Complete” as an absolute value must be innate and not as a contradiction of complimentary of incompleteness.

The suffix “*ktā*” denoting *nishtha* — is subjective and hence the etymological meaning of the term poornam will be – complete by itself, one who manifests as complete. This makes poornata or completion the essential virtue instead of some a priori or a posteriori stage of manifestation.

Adas is a pronoun that is traditionally taken as denoting subjective portion of he phenomena, and *idam* the objective one. Complete generates complete is more like saying that infinity plus infinity is equal to infinity, and infinity minus infinity is zero. The very virtue of infinity is, that it can never be added or subtracted and least from infinity itself. Therefore, out of infinity as the source and infinity as the produce, either one must be virtual. A virtual notion of infinity cannot generate a real value of infinity so it must be concluded that all other functions of the “complete” are virtual and hence hypothetical. Infinity as the substratum is the only existent entity.

Usually thinkers avert such prolonged reasoning and try to jump into a hackneyed conclusion that all these are intellectual notions and they are of little avail when it comes to spiritual experience.

Persistent intellectual engrossment has been highly spoken of in the shastras’ right view point through conducive commitment which is of great importance. This however doesn’t pertain to aspirants with meagre intellectual privilege. For them, transcendence must begin with mind or heart. They can control their minds and love god from the bottom of their heart. For promulgating the intellect into the supreme it takes more than just cognitive prowess, it takes a seasoning of the *prajna* [samskara of prajna] through integrating various theorems, postulates and tenets of metaphysics in order to develop a refined process of rational analysis that leads to permanent transcendence of all apparatus of cognition.

[itiriyā aupaniśad]

There are two successive modes of engrossment given in the Bhagvat Geeta-

“Mayi ev mana adhatsa my budhim niveshaya.”

Merge your mind in me and dissolve your intellect in me.

Merging the mind is not subjugating the mind or annihilating it, but seasoning it. Mind functions through five channels of perceptions – all of these should be pervaded by the innermost self, and the mind will merge automatically. If we isolate mind as a different entity and then force it to seek absorption in the self or paramatma, that would lead to an entirely opposite result.

Mind is engrossed due to excessive attachment or a sense of excessive agreeability. It retires due a sense of excessive disagreeability or avarice. Both lead to the stages called *laya* and *vikshepa*.

Distraction and dissolution - Distraction as the lord puts it in the Gita, is over come with practice and absorption with dispassion.

Abhyasen tu kaunteya vairagyen cha grihyate vairagyabhyam tannirodhah.

Now coming back to the intellect — *mayi budhim niveshaya* – this is a very subtle process. Had the lord as the inner self not been the substratum of all cognition, volition and rational faculties there would not have been anything called niveshanam or merging of the individual mind into the principle of cosmic intelligence.

Like every where else, we have a bifurcation of discursive tradition. Hindu counterparts of idealists maintain that knowledge is a priori of experience whereas the rationalist or empiricist counterpart syllogism school propounds otherwise, experience generates knowledge so experience is a priori of knowledge. *Baudha sarve pratyayah* — they say that all notions are intellectual or rational. Whereas an idealism asserts the ideal nature of the universal phenomena.

In the case of a rationalist and their Hindu counterpart there can be no merging of the intellect in the innermost self firstly because they have no notion of a supra-mental experience and secondly the inner self or atman is only a part of the objective phenomena.

Mayi budhim niveshaya is possible only when intelligence is a mediating agency of cognition which in turn is governed by pure unconditioned consciousness or paramatama.

There was one jeevan mukta adept at Gangotri. He spent most of his life in desolate inner reaches of the Himalaya mostly in hutments and caverns. His name was Swami Narayananand Tirth but he was popularly known as Narhari ji. There was a heresy that he had also studied Vedanta under Swami Tapovanam Ji Maharaj. He would keep his eyes shut most of the time and would rebuke and turn out any one who had anything except metaphysics and spirituality to discuss in his presence.

He used to instruct people through easy illustrations — he asked an aspirant sitting nearby to pick up a piece of coal, it was cold and black. Why is this different from a burning piece of coal?

This is because it has separated from fire. A burning coal that is in direct contact with fire also shares the virtues of fire like combustibility, effulgence, etc. Similarly, if the intellect is incessantly cogitating about the self, it gets seasoned and such an intellect is very easy to transcend. Transcending the intelligence means its merger into the supreme self.

One of the secondary Upanishad says, “*Na vichar paro yasya chittam sa mrit ityuchyate.*”

The moment one ceases to cogitate on the essential nature of his self stops discriminating between the real and virtual, transitory and eternal, self and not self subjectivity and objectivity — he ceases to live. He dies. This is an intellectual death. Physical death doesn't mark the essential “being of a creative man his creativity survives his physical death, but the moment he ceases to be creative, he is dead, since a person who is not meditative and creative is not his self.”

All intellectuals dwell at an ideal plane — so the cessation of contemplation is their extinction.

It is only in these days of rapid mass communication that we visualise or get in touch with authors — in the preceding millennium the only address of a man of creativity was his creation — as long as his creation lasted he “lived”. What kills him is the interruption in his creative venture.

From a subtler stand point even conceptualised creativity is very much “creativity” as conducive cognitive functions lead to the — “living” of a man of creativity and the cessation of such function not due to physiological disorder but due to sudden removal of inspiration or impetus is his death.

Fixing the mind on the self is not an objective phenomena — it would require only an exercise of individual will power to realise the inner self and nothing else.

This is a metaphysical phenomena, as when the aspirant delves deep into the subtler realms, he gets nearer to the source. Compared to self evident conditioned gnosis of the self, intellectual functions and rational process is too gross. So all divergent and objective approaches are misgivings. Convergent sublimation of the relative conditioned phenomena culminating into the self evident gnosis of the self is only way. Hence, the lord doesn't learn about me or study massive volumes on spirituality, he gives a hint if you merge your mind in me i.e through attachment and merge your intellect in me through righteous and consistent reasoning, you will abide in me, not in flesh and blood or as a particle or jiva or monad — abiding in him is attaining unison, with his pure transcendental, and unconditioned conscious nature.

This incessant contemplation on one's conscious nature is the merger of the intelligence in him. Not as an objective entity but as the conscious substratum. There is a class of mendicants who want their conditioned intellect to go numb by using narcotic or remaining dead to world or some other tactics culminating into what is usually referred to as verity visarjanam. So that they attain unison with the absolute. This is a frequent occurrence but not a positive attitude. Since the supreme self is well beyond the three gunas and their functions — to transcend the objective phenomena, one can begin with any of the three gunas — sato guna is existence, rajo guna is consciousness and tamo guna is bliss or ananda. One can begin with any one of three — suppose an aspirant begins with sato, he will be a righteous and meritorious being who will go to higher and more advanced realms. Devotees or bhaktas want this path. If one were to begin with raja he will have Chita or awareness and will become a yogi or mystic.

Anand leads to casual realm. If one were to flow the course of Anand he will become a yogi of a special description — according to Sage Panatela they are absorbed in the unmanifest nature their attainment is called bhava pratyaya .

But in the turya or the fourth state of consciousness [also called superconsciousness] one is pure sattwa or vishudha satva, so presumable all path promising the transcendence of three gunas through adherence to tama, or raja, etc., are not worthwhile.

Raja is dynamic it will make a workaholic out of you, tama is absorption and nescience, this may make one irresponsible and creative in a negative sense. It is only through satva that one can attain vishudha satva, even though turya or the transcendental one is equally pervasive in all three states — nearance semblance to turya is jagrit. A not sleep or dream [this is according to agama shastra-in tantras — the definitions of awaking and dream or sleeping are a bit different.

Tantras are the pragmatic canons of mysticism, so the glossary has been devised in order to suit the methodology and benefit part of mysticism. Hence, awakening is not the conventional awakening, it is the gnosis, the state of incessant pure and unconditioned awareness.

Similarly, sleep is the oblivion of the elements like kala, etc., *kala vilupta vibhavah san sa pashu smritah*. An aspirant who is oblivious of the grandeur of his kala is called a beast. This oblivion is automatic i.e., due to the absence of a steady flow of awareness regarding one's subjective nature. A beast is literally asleep because of his profound nescience.

Swapno vikalpah — dream is imagery — this again emanates from the non conducive flow of awareness – which according to tantraloka has to be refined [vikalpa smskarah]

Notion of subjective completion-

There is also a concept of Shiva swap and pashu swap — the state of a perfect being in which he pervades all three states and that of a commoner who has no stream line of awareness or memory connecting these three or four states. The state of absolutely no objectivity awareness is what mysticism understands as completeness, the three variants are only from the view point of time space and substance. Poorna aka Ananta is essentially an abstract notion with no such conditionings .

“Sa me indro maedhaya sprunotu amritasya devadharano bhuyasam” -

May Indra bestow refined intellect unto me through which I may be able to bear the essence of immortality.

Parapsychological Phenomena

[Bhoomi Sati]

Before the developments in the scientific realm, the causation of all physical phenomena was understood extremely poorly. One relied on unembodied or supernatural evidence to explain various occurrences. This evidence turned out to be called “Parapsychological phenomena”, which indicates events that cannot be deemed by the natural law. It counts for knowledge that is acquired by anything other than our sensory abilities. There are two types of parapsychological phenomena: cognitive, i.e., where a person is believed to have gained knowledge about something without the usage of ordinary sensory channels. The knowledge gained can be about the future or concerning other people’s thoughts. Types of cognitive parapsychological phenomena are telepathy, clairvoyance, and precognition. The other type of parapsychological phenomena is Physical, which involves a person’s will to physically move things in their own way without actually moving them, therefore, influencing its movement. The study of parapsychological phenomena is called Parapsychology. There has been a widespread belief since the earliest of times about this phenomenon. Scientific influence over the world took decades to develop. Antecedent to that, it was paranormal activities that people used to believe in. Debates over the same are still ongoing, about the relevance and presence of such phenomena. Parapsychology not only studies “psychic” phenomena but also mental abilities like telepathy and telekinesis. Even though psychic phenomena have their roots quite deep in history, Joseph Banks Rhine has been titled as the founder of Parapsychology as a science or as a branch of Psychology. He did a series of experiments around extrasensory perception at Duke University with the help of his colleagues. Before that, there had been many experiments on telepathy, hypnosis, hauntings, apparitions, etc, which later came into various types of psychic phenomena.

There is a various number of parapsychological phenomena studied by researchers and scientists; a few of them listed below :

Telepathy -

Telepathy is the relay of thoughts or knowledge from one person to another through the means of anything but the five senses. It is the direct transference of thoughts without the usage of sensory communication channels. Telepathy hasn’t been fully proven yet, but there have been studies conducted that hint towards its existence using ways such as card guessing with a special deck of five sets of five cards. This technique involves a person trying to set cards in random order and another person trying to guess the order in which the cards have been kept.

Clairvoyance -

Clairvoyance is obtaining information or knowledge about a far, distant place with the help of unscientific methods. It is claimed as gaining information about things through extrasensory perception, i.e., gaining information without the help of the sensory organs. Although clairvoyance hasn’t exactly been proven scientifically, it has had its fair share of history. Since the beginning, there have been various places and times in which individuals have asserted themselves or others to be clairvoyant. In several religions as well there have been stories of people claiming to be clairvoyant. For example, various Christian saints were said to have the ability to see or know things that were far taken out from their nearby tangible insight as a sort of blessing from God, including Columba of Iona, Padre Pio, and Anne Catherine Emmerich. Jesus Christ in the Gospels is additionally recorded as having the ability to know things that were far taken out from his nearby human insight. In Jainism, clairvoyance is viewed as one of the five sorts of knowledge.

The beings of hell and heaven (devas) are said to have clairvoyance by birth. As indicated by the Jain text Sarvārthasiddhi, "this kind of knowledge has been called avadhi as it ascertains matter in downward range or knows objects within limits".

Precognition -

Precognition is the impression of data about future spots or occasions before they happen. It is the psychic ability to see things in the future. Just like telepathy and clairvoyance, precognition takes place without the assistance of normal senses, hence it is also a form of extrasensory perception. Also, like many other parapsychic phenomena, precognition hasn't been scientifically proven. It contravenes the principles of causality, that an effect cannot occur before its cause. And even though there is a great deal of evidence and many people's experiences to back up the phenomena of precognition, the evidence still hasn't been accepted as scientific proof.

Psychokinesis -

Psychokinesis is the ability to move, or influence, matter without any physical force. It is basically about moving objects with the help of mental influence or power. Again, psychokinesis has been considered as pseudoscience, and scientific evidence to support its existence is lacking. For example, in a psychokinetic test, the subject rolls a dice and tries to roll it up to a particular number with the help of his/her mental abilities, causing the dice to end up on a certain number.

The conversation about parapsychological marvels has now and again expected emotional hints, unacceptable to scientific order, and frank yet conflicting suppositions are still as often as possible voiced. Adherents and nonbelievers may put together their conviction or doubt regarding what they consider to be the logical proof, on their encounters, or on some bigger arrangement of mentalities and qualities into which ESP does or doesn't fit. At the point when such limits and opposing perspectives are generally held, it is practically sure that the proof isn't decisive whichever way and that sure ends are probably not going to be upheld by an overview of the multitude of well-established realities.

Near-Death Experience

A near-death experience (NDE) is a significant individual encounter related to death or approaching passing which specialists guarantee share comparative qualities. At the point when good, such encounters may envelop an assortment of sensations including separation from the body, sensations of levitation, all-out quietness, security, warmth, the experience of outright disintegration, and the presence of a light. At the point when negative, such encounters may incorporate feelings of torment and trouble. There are both religious and scientific explanations for Near-Death Experiences. Neuroscience suggests that NDE occurs because of "disturbed bodily multisensory integration" whereas religious beliefs talk about near-death experiences in context to the afterlife. Near-death experiences, or NDEs, are set off during particularly dangerous scenes when the body is harmed by dull injury, a cardiovascular failure, asphyxia, stun, etc. Around one of every 10 patients with heart failure in a medical clinic setting goes through such a scene. A large number of overcomers of these nerve-racking sticky circumstances recount abandoning their harmed bodies and experiencing a domain past ordinary presence, unconstrained by the typical limits of reality. These amazing, supernatural encounters can prompt a lasting change in their lives. They are basically like a brush with death.

NDEs are not extravagant trips of the creative mind. They share expansive shared traits like experiencing no pain, different types of visual phenomena, separating from one's body and floating above it, or in any event, taking off into space (out-of-body encounters). They may incorporate gathering friends and family, living or dead, or otherworldly creatures

like holy messengers or even a twisted feeling of existence. There are some basic physiological clarifications for these discernments, like logically narrowing the exclusive focus. Decreased bloodstream to the visual outskirts of the retina implies vision misfortune happens there first. People's encounters with NDEs to a great extent depend on their religious or cultural beliefs. For example, many people in the US believe in guardian angels, hence their near-death experiences might include the same. And as for Hindus, it could include the god of death. Near-death experiences can either be positive or negative. The positive experiences are associated with a divine feeling and something out of this world. While sometimes the experience can be quite traumatic as well. People can see things that can be extremely disturbing which could lead to a negative connotation.

Kenneth Ring subdivided this experience into five sub-divisions:

1. Peace
2. Body separation
3. Entering darkness
4. Seeing the light
5. Entering another land of existence

There are numerous explanations for this experience. There are three broad groups of explanations for the same, which aren't considered the same but overlap greatly. There are spiritual and transcendental theories that interpret NDE as something exactly what it appears to be to the person having the experience. This was proposed by Chris French. The psychological explanations include the depersonalization, expectancy, and dissociation model. The depersonalization model was given by a professor of psychiatry Russell Noyes and clinical therapist Roy Kletti, which recommended that the NDE is a type of depersonalization experienced under conditions like hazardous risk, conceivably unpreventable peril. They presumed NDE as a sort of hallucination. As per this model, the individuals who face their passing isolate themselves from the environmental factors and their bodies, presently don't feel feelings, and experience time twists. Another psychological theory is known as the expectancy model. It has been recommended that albeit these encounters could be thought of as true, they had been developed in the mind, either intentionally or subliminally, in light of the pressure of an experience with death (or saw experience with death), and didn't relate to a genuine occasion. The dissociation model signifies that near-death experiences save the experiencer from an extremely stressful or pressure-causing event. There are also physiological explanations for near-death experiences. They include hypotheses of various activities of neurotransmitters, endorphins, cerebral hypoxia, anoxia, and hypercapnia.

Be it any theory, it is no surprise that these experiences are a big play of the mind. It is surely intriguing how what may be low levels of oxygen or blood loss can be perceived as either something blissful to one person or something highly traumatic to another. NDEs have been with us through all times, cultures, religions, and ages. To those brought up in religious practices, the clearest clarification is that they were allowed a dream of heaven or hell, of what anticipates them in the great beyond. Curiously, NDEs are not any more prone to happen in ardent devotees than in common or nonpracticing subjects.

Out of Body Experience

An out-of-body insight (OBE), which some may likewise portray as a dissociative scene, is an effect of your consciousness leaving your body. These scenes are regularly revealed by individuals who've had near-death experiences. Individuals ordinarily experience self from inside their actual body. One no doubt sees their general surroundings from their vantage point. In any case, during an OBE, one may feel as though they are outside themselves, taking a gander at their body from another viewpoint. OBEs can be instigated

by traumatic brain wounds, tactile deprivation, near-death experiences, dissociative and hallucinogenic medications, lack of hydration, rest problems, dreaming, and electrical incitement of the brain, among different causes. An out-of-body experience feels like a sensation of gliding outside your body, a modified view of the world, for example, peering down from a stature, the inclination that you're peering down at yourself from a higher place, a feeling that what's going on is genuine. They don't usually last for long and happen suddenly. There are spontaneous OBEs and induced OBEs. When talking about spontaneous OBEs, there are three main types, one of them being near sleep or during sleep. Many people who report having out-of-body experiences say that it is preceded by a lucid dream-like state. A huge level of these cases allude to circumstances where the sleep was not especially profound (because of sickness, commotions in different rooms, pressure, fatigue from work, regular re-arousing, and so forth) In the greater part of these cases subjects see themselves as being conscious; about a portion of them note a sensation of rest loss of motion. A near-death experience is also a form of spontaneous out-of-body experience. Some people report having OBEs when they've experienced traumatic accidents, hence leading to a near-death experience. Spontaneous OBEs also result from extreme physical effort. The other type of out-of-body experience, i.e., induced OBEs includes chemical OBEs which include giving hallucinogens to induce an out-of-body-like experience. It also includes mental or mechanical induction.

Two major theories explain out-of-body experiences, i.e. **Psychological and Paranormal**. The psychological theory considers out-of-body experiences as experiences that are dissociative which result from different neurological and psychological factors. Researchers consider OBEs as a kind of dream-like experience where the consciousness is altered. It was said by James H. Hyslop that OBEs happen when the movement of the psyche mind performs certain pictures to give the impression the subject is in an alternate actual area. In psychological theory, OBEs have also been connected to psychosis and hysteria. In the paranormal theory, it has been proposed that out-of-body experiences are not a result of bodily experiences or aren't related to the mind or aren't either psychological. Whereas, it results when a soul, spirit detaches itself from the body and goes to another location. In old Indian sacred texts, such a condition of awareness is additionally alluded to as Turiya, which can be accomplished by profound yogic and thoughtful exercises, during which a yogi might be freed from the duality of brain and body, permitting them to deliberately leave the body and afterward get back to it. The body completing this excursion is classified as "*Vigyan Dehi*" ("*Scientific body*").

There's some discussion about whether the sensations and discernments related to OBEs happen genuinely or as a kind of dreamlike experience. A recent report attempted to investigate this by taking a gander at psychological mindfulness in 101 individuals who had endured heart failure. The creators tracked down that 13% of the members felt a detachment from their bodies during revival. Yet, just 7% revealed a consciousness of occasions they wouldn't have seen from their real point of view. Moreover, two members detailed having both visual and auditory encounters while in heart failure. Just one was all-around ok to follow up, yet he gave a precise, nitty-gritty portrayal of what occurred for around three minutes of his revival from heart failure. In any case, there's no scientific proof to support the possibility that an individual's cognizance can go external to the body.

There is no solid reason for what causes out-of-body experiences. OBEs can happen as a result of extreme stress or trauma. As per 2017 research looking into the experience of women in labor, OBEs during labor aren't strange. The investigation didn't explicitly link OBEs to post-traumatic stress disorder however the creators called attention to the fact that women who had OBEs had either gone through injury during work or another circumstance not identified with labor. OBEs have also been linked to medical conditions

like epilepsy, migraine, cardiac arrest, anxiety, depression, etc. Medication like anesthesia can also be a cause of out-of-body experiences.

Regardless of whether your consciousness can genuinely leave your actual body hasn't been deductively demonstrated. However, numerous individuals have announced comparative effects of their consciousness leaving their body for quite a long time. OBEs seem, by all accounts, to be more normal for certain conditions, including certain dissociative issues and epilepsy. Numerous individuals additionally report having an OBE during a near-death experience, including electric stun or injury.

Subtle Body

As described in the Bhagavad Gita, the subtle body is the combination of the mind, ego,, and intellect. It is the subtle body that governs the physical body. As per the Hindu and yogic way of thinking, an individual is made out of three bodies; the *Karana sharira* (causal body), *sukshma sharira* (subtle body), and *Karya sharira* (net actual body). The subtle body is viewed as the different vigorous layers that make up an individual's past genuineness. it comprises three out of the five koshas (sheaths) of human life:

- *Pranamaya kosha*: the sheath of essential life power/energy
- *Manomaya kosha*: the psychological or mental sheath
- *Vijnanamaya kosha*: the sheath of shrewdness and insight

The subtle body is depicted in antiquated Indian messages like the Upanishads and the Bhagavad Gita, in which it is portrayed as exuding from the causal body, and showing and controlling all parts of the actual body. Every one of the three bodies is interconnected, and ideal living happens when they are in amiability with each other. It is accepted that the inconspicuous body immigrates after actual passing, working as a model for resurrection. Adding to the Sanskrit name *sukshma sharira*, the subtle body is in some cases alluded to as the *linga sharira* (astral body).

[Ms. Bhoomi Sati is pursuing Honors in Psychology from DU. She is also volunteering for YTA.]

The science of Shakti

Shakta Vijnam of somanand.

Abstract

Somananda the first known exponent of trika school of thought which founded the difficult upon which the entire gamut of ishwara dwait, pratyabhijna and krama tantricism of Kashmir.

Just as Shiv drishti is an exposition of dialectics of Shaivite monism Shakta I janam is a compendium of arcane methods of Shakti awakening and rotating her along side various plexuses.

The author has divided the entire process into thirteen steps which as per their gradations of subtlety can only be learnt theoretically till a competent preceptor enters the novice by identifying himself as the primordial Shakti residing within the disciples subtle psychic plexuses. Each one of these thirteen steps are discussed with due elaboration in this series of articles.

Key words

Chakras, kundalini, petals, nada soochi, vedha,kanda, nadi, magna mater, dakshin path, kaula, trika.

This is a less known works attributed to somanand Nath. This is rather a concise of various tantrik techniques ubiquitously found in various tantric and agamic canons. Somanand Nath has arranged all of them in one place to facilitate the process of awakening and rotating the kundalini power in various plexuses. The approach varies in many ways from the conventional methods as per the most of agamas including satchakranirupana by punyanand nath which are considered as standard methods in this lore.

The thirteen steps or various stages of the entire process of awakening of the Shakti are not popular since in other tantras the main focus is on rotating the awareness [in the form of kundalini or the serpent power] in various petals of the chakras and dissolving them into one another successively till all of them with their respective alphabetic configuration, elements, yoginis, presiding deities and various peripheries of the shrichakram and gradations of nada - merge first into Shakti and then into shiva as the absolute principle or paramshiva. *Sthanam* or location of various chakras in this parlance are various mystic centres within the subtle body. Entrance is focusing the awareness and leading it upwards towards subtler realms through what one tantrik canon calls - *vedhayet nad suchina* - pierce these points by the needle of nada. This explains how subtle and arduous is the process of experiencing these plexuses within ones own gross body and then transcending them by streamlining the consciousness and orientating the impetus of its flow to reach the twelfth and even the seventeenth apex where an aspirant attains unison with the all pervasive shiva. The frequent term for the process of transcendence in swachhanda tantra is “*tyajet*” which implies inculcating dispassion for the fiction of seat in the preceding plexuses in order to rise higher up to attain ones completer and essential nature .

This concise treatise named Shakti vojnanam or literally the great science of Shakti has thirteen steps viz;

1. Location स्थानम्
2. Entrance प्रवेश :
3. Form रूपं
4. Goal. लक्षं

5. Characteristics लक्षणं
6. Arousal उत्थापनं
7. Awakening बोधनम्
8. Resting in the plexuses चक्रविश्रान्ति
9. As ending tages भूमिकागमनं
10. Introvert state अंतःवस्था
11. Resort विश्रमपरिणामः
12. modification
13. Returning आगमनम्

This thirteen-fold science or awareness of Shakti has been indicated personally by Lord Shiva in all the discipline of trika school. In classical Sanskrit i.e. *Jnana krit vijnanam* is often translated as - science but ancient doyens of eastern metaphysical thought while commenting on this term specially while commenting on the verse of Geeta - *Jnana Vijnanakala triptatma Kutasth vijitendriya* - have translated the term Vijnanakala as the direct subjective experience of what has been learnt.

The authorship of this treatise is attributed to Somanand the compiler of Shivdrishti. Shivdrishti focuses rather more on refuting and rejection of almost all other stand points from the popular six systems of the conventional Indian philosophy and as an appendix to the principle canon has propounded the Shakti vijnanam. Which emphasises more on the methodology culminating into the direct subjective experience of one all pervasive nature. There is absolutely no discursive exposition in this small work. Notwithstanding this does not turn out to be a “teach yourself” type of manual since the energy required for the entire delicate and subtle process of arousal and depending of the primordial power and kundalini Shakti must come from its eternal reservoir i.e. the guru who is not different from Shiva and/or Shakti.

Na heechha aodanam asya prerakatwen vartatge kontu atm bala sparshat [uruso tatsamo bhavet]

Merely exerting one's will power does not motivate this course but the “contact of the power of purusa” leads an aspirant to the ultimate union.

Five fingers below the navel and two fingers above the penis there are psychic plexus called “kanda” the same is also termed as *chakra sthanam*. An aspirant should focus on this plexus by controlling the flow of outgoing and incoming breath. There is another method for visualising these chakras given in certain tantras - focus the lord of the senses in the navel center. Although in thesis in the context of Khechari Mudra in Swachhanda Tantra and Tantraloka 32nd Ahinika, this also leads to the focusing the awareness at one point from where the aspirant can “locate” various psychic centres in his subtle body. Without this, this would be merely his own mind and imagination playing a trick on him as is usually the case among modern practitioners of tantrik yoga which is sadly lacking patience and sincerity. Awareness of these points is a spontaneous process and does not have to rely on pictures or descriptive reflections.

“The six petal lotus mentioned in the tantras
Has a pod in which there is mystic triangle
the sign of primordial causation.”

Within the delta there is the seat of primordial word of god AUM. Within this the manga mater of the entire universe resides in the form of kundalini.

O! Aspirants surrender to the universal mother who manifests in the form of Shyama*

There is a great mystery behind why there is more emphasis on the saral plexus as the center of departure and arrival of kundalini in trika techniques. Dakshina path has the vishranti chakran in the crown of the head i.e. sahasra, kaula path on the other hand considers the perptitual seat of the serpent power in the coccyx or muladhar. Mixed path

can shift polarity depending on what they want most of all - enjoyments, emancipation or both in succession. There is an arcane practice of awakening the kundalini only upto swadhisthanam and staying there till the last hour. Till the kundalini is in the swadhisthana the shakta practitioner has to abide by certain strict injunctions pertaining to martial discipline which are not disclosed to the uninitiated. Most of such yogic practices are either obsolete or have been corrupted.

A kalika is jeevan mukta - at the time of his death he takes the power from from the swadhisthanam to sahasr ara and above the crown of the head and attains *videh mukti* (body less emancipation), for this he must practice the circulation of his spiritual energy from his groin center to the twelfth end dwadashant and back. This is also the seat of creativity aesthetics, poetry dance and drama. Unlike the stoic moderation of a Shiv yogi who wants a total absorption in his essential nature an aspirant of Shakta vijnana can eat the cake and have it too.

To be contd.

- * यत्षट्पत्रं कमलमुदितं तपस्याकर्णिकाख्या
- * योनिस्तस्या : प्रथितमुदरे यत्तदोकारपीठं तस्मिन्तःकुचभरनतां
- * कुंडलीतः प्रवृत्तांश्यामाकारांसकलजननीसंततंसन्निधिताम् ।।

**

श्यामा is a legendary nayika (a form of Shakti) whose touch is cold in summers and hot in the winters.

Paranand Swami.

for Rumi's 'The wound is the place where the Light enters you.'

If the wound is the place where light enters through,
then I am shot with white and gold;
I pulse infinitely in geometric patterns.

If the wound is point of origins,
the gate after gate of heaven, then my body-being
must be the paradise I had quite forgotten.^[SEP]

I ask for that wholeness to enwrap me
beyond time and fragmentation.

If wound you speak of is a paradigm of welcome,
then I am that curtain that parts and all light subsumes
my all and you – for what is a repast made of?

If wound is a cry of longing, then light is that love
that makes me whole and you. Stitches us up
with sutures beyond skin – nerves enlivening

even passersby waiting for a sip of rain.

This bird of my heart sings, so I be not
forgotten, nor the hem of my skirt.

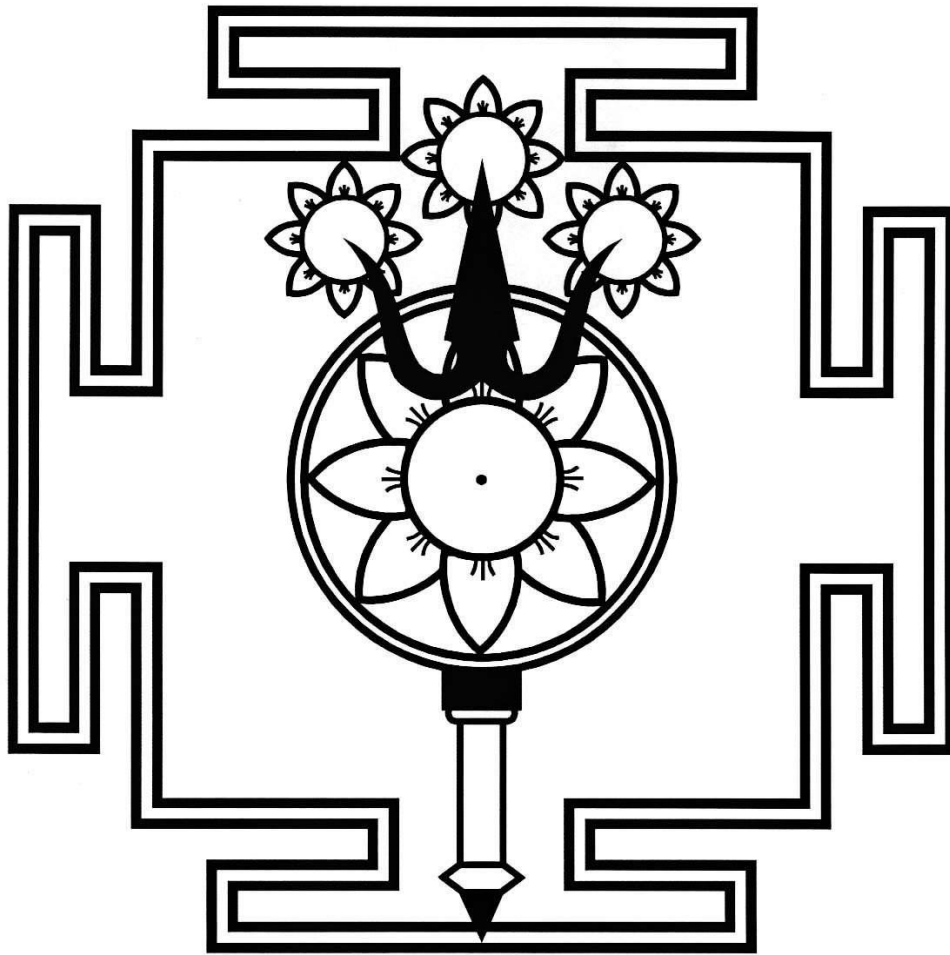
- Ambika Talwar

[Prof. Talwar teaches creative arts in the US. Her poems are deep abstraction with edifice of eastern metaphysical insight innate to her early upbringing.]

From the Brush of Bhoomi Sati

Painting the moon and a bough .





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